

10/07 WEDNESDAY — STORY OUTLINE

Airdate: Wednesday, October 7, 2026 · **Stories:** A + B + C, confirmed by the producer 9/29 (jeff_approval.md) · **Guest:** none · **Sponsor:** OmniWatch (2 breaks) · **Stage:** beats

RUNNING ORDER

Slot	What	Weight	Clips
Tease	Face-match arrest, the grocery cart watching you, the drive-thru robot backlash	—	—
A	A computer said it was her face... she spent months in jail	~45% of show	5
Break	OmniWatch — after A	—	—
B	Your grocery store is watching every step you take	~30%	3
Break	OmniWatch — after B	—	—
C	They replaced the cashier with a robot... now they're bringing the humans back	~20%	3
End	End of show	—	—

The show in three sentences

A computer matched a Tennessee grandmother's face to a bank thief in a state she'd never been to, and she sat in jail for months before anyone checked. The same kind of watching is in your grocery store: carts with cameras, baskets that ping the ceiling, cameras that log your aisles and your plate. Then the exhale: the fast-food chains are admitting you hated the robots and are bringing people back, and here is how to get one.

The ride

Dread builds through A (arrested at gunpoint, months inside, nobody checked), stays uneasy through B but turns practical at the phone fix, and lets go in C, which is a good-news, slightly funny close.

Decisions before we write

- A's victim is 50: a grandmother, just under the 55+ line. And A's fix is thin (lock photos, keep an alibi trail, demand the face-match report). Enough for an A?
- B, per Jeff: lead with the grocery AI cart and Lowe's cameras, not Target. Keep B beat 2 (the viral Target-worker TikTok, B's only person) without naming the brand, or drop it?
- B beat 1 wants vertical cart b-roll; a horizontal company video would be a crop. B beat 3 has no person, just Lowe's own privacy statement over plate-camera footage.
- C beat 1 replaces Jeff's drive-thru test (he won't shoot one) with a viral AI drive-thru fail. Frame C as "bringing the humans back," not "ditching the robots": McDonald's is doing both.

A. A COMPUTER SAID IT WAS HER FACE... SHE SPENT MONTHS IN JAIL

In one sentence: Police ran a fake-ID photo through AI face recognition, it returned a Tennessee grandmother who had never been to North Dakota, and she sat in jail for months until her own bank records freed her.

Peg: She filed a \$10 million federal lawsuit against Fargo and the detective on Sept 16; CBS, ABC and NBC picked it up that week.

Weight: ~45% of show · 5 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The hook	You (the viewer)	Police can run your face through a computer, and a match can be treated like proof.	JEFF
2	The arrest	Angela Lipps, Tennessee grandmother of five	Police arrest her while she is babysitting, for bank fraud in North Dakota, a state she has never been to.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — Lipps interview, WDAY or network
3	The match	West Fargo police investigator	A photo from the real suspect's fake ID goes into AI face recognition, and the system returns her.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — network explainer on the match
4	Months inside	Angela Lipps	She sits in jail for months until her lawyer's bank records prove she was home; charges dropped Christmas Eve.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — Lipps on the jail time
5	"Errors were made"	Dave Zibolski, then-Fargo police chief	In March the chief admits errors, apologizes and issues a new facial-recognition policy.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — March press conference
6	The lawsuit	Eric Rice, Lipps' attorney	She sues Fargo and the former detective for \$10 million in federal court.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — lawsuit coverage, CBS or KSTP
7	Could it be you	You (the viewer)	A face match is supposed to be a lead, not an ID, and many searches start from public social-media photos.	JEFF
8	The fix	You (the viewer)	Jeff locks his public photos down to friends-only on his own phone, live.	DEMO

The fix

- Set Facebook and Instagram profile and tagged photos to friends-only. (*verify which systems scrape social media*)
- Keep an alibi trail: bank and card records and phone location history are what freed her.
- If you're ever charged, have your lawyer demand the facial-recognition report and whether a human confirmed it.

Gaps

- ⚠ Beat 2: "arrested at gunpoint" is her attorney's framing. Attribute it to him, don't state it.
- ⚠ Beat 4: jail time varies by outlet (about six months per ABC and MPR, three per WCTI). Say "months" until the complaint is pulled.
- ⚠ Beat 4: "lost her home and car" is from ABC's summary of the suit. Pull the complaint.
- ⚠ Beat 7: that the search began from her social-media photo is one ABC line. Confirm in the complaint before the fix leans on it.

B. YOUR GROCERY STORE IS WATCHING EVERY STEP YOU TAKE

In one sentence: The new AI grocery carts point cameras into your basket and out at the aisle, store baskets carry beacons that talk to the lights overhead, and home-store cameras log which aisles you walked and read your plate, but you can switch off the part that ties it to your phone.

Peg: Instacart says it tripled Caper Cart deployments in a year, now 100+ cities in 15 states, rolling at Kroger, ShopRite, Schnucks, Sprouts, Wegmans, Weis and Geissler's.

Weight: ~30% of show · 3 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The AI cart	Grocery shopper with a Caper Cart	The cart has cameras into your basket and out at the aisle, a location tracker, and ads by where you stand.	FIND · VERTICAL BROLL — Caper Cart in an aisle
2	The beacon	Store worker who filmed it (Elijah, per his TikTok)	He films the black box on a store basket and calls it a tracker; 3.4 million people watch.	HAVE · VERTICAL — TikTok @user60342208753
3	The cameras	Lowe's, per its privacy statement	Cameras log which aisles you walk and how long you stay; some parking lots read your plate.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — plate cameras at a home store
4	The fix	You (the viewer)	Jeff shuts off location and Bluetooth for store apps on his phone, live.	DEMO

The fix

- iPhone: Settings → Privacy & Security → Location Services → each store app → Never. Then Settings → the app → Bluetooth off.
- Android: Settings → Apps → the store app → Permissions → Location → Don't allow. (*verify on Jeff's device*)
- With location and Bluetooth off, the basket tracks a basket, not you. The cameras and plate readers don't need your phone; those you can't switch off.

Gaps

- △ Beat 2 is Target's basket. Jeff wants the story off Target: keep the clip without naming the brand in copy, or drop it (see Decisions).
- △ Beat 2: the "tracker" claim is his; Snopes confirmed the beacon tracks the basket and the store app ties it to you. Air it with that caveat.
- △ Beat 3: no named person. It's Lowe's own privacy statement plus plate-camera footage.
- Jeff's Jan 22 "These Stores Are Spying On You" covered store tracking. New here: the AI carts and the basket beacon.

C. THEY REPLACED THE CASHIER WITH A ROBOT... NOW THEY'RE BRINGING THE HUMANS BACK

In one sentence: After years of kiosks and AI drive-thru voices, Burger King says customers drove off rather than talk to the bot, and McDonald's starts retraining more than two million workers to be nicer to you.

Peg: McDonald's "Make It Golden" hospitality training starts Oct 5, two days before air. Burger King's tech chief said Sept 23 that pilot restaurants saw drive-offs.

Weight: ~20% of show · 3 clip beats

#	Beat	Who	What happens	Clip
1	The robot fails	Drive-thru customer filming an AI order	The AI voice gets the order wrong again and again while the customer films it.	FIND · VERTICAL — viral AI drive-thru fail
2	They drove away	Chakri Somisetti, Burger King VP of brand technology	He says pilot restaurants saw drive-offs because guests didn't want to talk to a bot.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — news on the Burger King drive-offs
3	The humans come back	McDonald's worker (unnamed)	McDonald's starts hospitality training for 2 million-plus workers Oct 5, while still rolling out its AI voice.	FIND · HORIZONTAL — McDonald's retraining news
4	Get a person	You (the viewer)	Walk in and order at the counter, or ask for a person at the speaker.	JEFF

The fix

- Want a person? Walk in and order at the counter. McDonald's says it wants an employee on hand for anyone who prefers one. (*verify at the store*)
- At the speaker, ask for a person. (*verify what works at each chain*) Burger King's human option isn't live yet.
- Watch the order screen as you talk and fix it before you pay; check the bag before you leave the lot.

Gaps

- △ Beat 1: Jeff won't record his own drive-thru test. This needs a real customer's fail clip, and the famous ones are older (Taco Bell, McDonald's 2024). Old footage is fine, the peg is new.
- △ Beat 3: no named McDonald's person. The retraining is a company announcement.
- △ Don't say "McDonald's is hiring cashiers" (not found) or "Burger King is ditching the bot" (voice AI is still in about 1,500 drive-thrus).